

####	#####	#####		##	#####	#####	###	#	#	#####
#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#
#	#####	#####	#	#	#####	#####	#	#	#	###
#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#	#
#####	#	#	##	#	#	#	#	#	#####	#####

THE EXAM BLUEPRINT SYSTEM

U S E R ' S G U I D E

Version 1.0

For the Modern Web Browser (and spiritually, Windows 3.1)

[#####] [#####] [#####] THREE (3) 3.5" HD DISKETTES
 DISK 1/3 DISK 2/3 DISK 3/3 ENCLOSED*

* Diskettes are emotional, not physical. Software ships via GitHub(R) and Vercel(TM). Do not insert GitHub into drive A:.

SERIAL NO. CT-00001-AVL | REGISTER YOUR COPY TODAY (SEE BACK PAGE)

IMPORTANT -- READ BEFORE BREAKING SEAL

By opening this manual you agree to study. CFP/TRAILS is open-source software provided AS IS, with no warranty of merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose, or passing score. Unlike the software you bought in 1995, you may copy this product freely, give it to your co-workers, and modify it. We encourage it. That is the whole point.

TRADEMARK NOTICE: CFP(R) and CERTIFIED FINANCIAL PLANNER(R) are certification marks owned by the Certified Financial Planner Board of Standards, Inc. This product is a study aid only and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by CFP Board. All question content is original work written against the publicly available exam blueprint. Verify current-year dollar figures against official materials.

TECHNICAL SUPPORT: There is no 1-800 number. There is a GitHub Issues tab, which is somehow both better and worse.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1	WELCOME TO CFP/TRAILS	3
CHAPTER 2	SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS & INSTALLATION	3
CHAPTER 3	THE DASHBOARD (YOUR HOME BASE)	4
CHAPTER 4	TRAILS AND MODULES	5
CHAPTER 5	LEARN MODE: FLASH CARDS	6
CHAPTER 6	QUIZ MODE AND SCORING	6
CHAPTER 7	RANKS, BADGES, AND STREAKS	7
CHAPTER 8	ADDING YOUR OWN CONTENT	8
CHAPTER 9	TROUBLESHOOTING	9
APPENDIX A	THE EXAM BLUEPRINT	10
APPENDIX B	REGISTRATION CARD	10

CHAPTER 1: WELCOME TO CFP/TRAILS

Congratulations on your acquisition of CFP/TRAILS Version 1.0, the gamified study system for the CFP(R) examination. Where other study products give you a 900-page binder and a sense of dread, CFP/TRAILS gives you trails, points, badges, ranks, and a daily streak counter that will judge you silently.

THE BIG IDEA: The CFP Board publishes the exam's blueprint -- eight Principal Knowledge Domains, each with a published weight (e.g., Retirement is approximately 18% of the exam; Tax is approximately 14%). CFP/TRAILS organizes your study exactly the way the exam is built. Every trail is one domain. Every question is tagged to a blueprint topic code. Your dashboard reports **BLUEPRINT COVERAGE:** the weighted percentage of the actual exam your demonstrated mastery spans.

In other words: the amber bar is the exam. The green bar is you. Make the green bar bigger.

CHAPTER 2: SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS & INSTALLATION

2.1 SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED
-----	-----
Any web browser since ~2020	The same, but with coffee
Node.js 18+ (developers only)	Node.js 20+
4 MB RAM (1995 estimate)	Whatever your phone has
Mouse or finger	Both
VGA monitor, 256 colors	Honestly anything
Hard disk space: 0 bytes*	* progress stored in browser

2.2 INSTALLATION FROM DISKETTE (TRADITIONAL METHOD)

Insert DISK 1 into drive A:. Type A:\SETUP and press ENTER. When prompted, insert DISK 2, then DISK 3. NOTE: This method has not worked since approximately 1997 and the diskettes do not exist. Proceed to Section 2.3.

2.3 INSTALLATION (ACTUAL METHOD)

END USERS: Open the Vercel URL your administrator gives you.
Installation complete. Yes, really. Go study.

DEVELOPERS: C:\> git clone <your-github-repo-url>
C:\> cd cfp-trails
C:\> npm install (this is your DISK 1 through 3)
C:\> npm run dev (local copy at localhost:3000)

DEPLOYMENT: Push to GitHub. In Vercel: Add New Project -> import the repository -> Deploy. No environment variables.
Total elapsed time: less than rewinding a VHS tape.

CHAPTER 3: THE DASHBOARD (YOUR HOME BASE)

Upon launching CFP/TRAILS you arrive at the Dashboard. Figure 3-1 depicts the screen as rendered by our finest ASCII artist.

FIGURE 3-1: THE DASHBOARD

CFP/TRAILS [PARAPLANNER] 415 PTS * 6d STREAK			
THE EXAM BLUEPRINT - 8 DOMAINS - 170 QUESTIONS Study the exam the way it's built.			
BLUEPRINT COVERED	RANK Paraplanner	BADGES 4 (80%+)	STREAK 6 days
11.2%	385 to next		
TRAILS			
DOMAIN E 22Q 3 MODULES		DOMAIN F 23Q 3 MODULES	
Tax Planning		Retirement Savings & Inc.	
[####green####--amber--]		[##green##---amber---	
14% OF EXAM 52% MASTERED		18% OF EXAM 31% MASTERED	

KEY CONCEPT -- THE WEIGHT RULER: Each trail card contains a ruled bar. The AMBER fill is that domain's official share of the exam. The GREEN fill inside it is your average best-quiz mastery of that domain. BLUEPRINT COVERED is the sum of (domain weight x your mastery) across all live domains -- a single number answering the only question that matters: how much of the exam could I handle today?

Trails marked IN DEVELOPMENT are domains awaiting content. They are displayed so the blueprint is always honest about what you are NOT studying. This was a deliberate and slightly cruel design decision.

CHAPTER 4: TRAILS AND MODULES

Selecting a live trail opens its module list. A MODULE is a topic cluster (e.g., "IRAs, Roth & Distributions") containing flash cards and one quiz. Each module displays a status chip:

CHIP	MEANING
NEW	You have not attempted the quiz. Innocence.
BEST 65%	Attempted; your best score shown. Keep going.
* BADGE	Best score of 80% or higher. Wear it proudly.

Each module offers two buttons: LEARN (CARDS) and START QUIZ. The recommended workflow, validated by decades of office-manual tradition: read the cards, take the quiz, review the misses, retake. Repeat until the chip says BADGE.

CHAPTER 5: LEARN MODE: FLASH CARDS

Learn Mode presents flash cards one at a time. Click or tap the card to flip it. The front states a concept ("Dual basis rule for gifts"); the back states the rule with the exam trap highlighted. Navigation is via PREVIOUS and NEXT. The deck wraps around, like a cassette with auto-reverse.

FIGURE 5-1: A FLASH CARD, MID-FLIP (ARTIST'S RENDERING)

<pre> +-----+ Dual basis rule for gifts +-----+ </pre>	<pre> TAP ===> </pre>	<pre> +-----+ If FMV at gift < donor's basis: donor basis for gains, FMV for losses. Between the two: NO gain or loss. (Exam trap!) +-----+ </pre>
CARD 01/05 - TAP TO FLIP		

Viewing a card for the first time counts toward your daily streak. The software notices. The software always notices.

CHAPTER 6: QUIZ MODE AND SCORING

Quiz Mode delivers the module's questions in sequence. Select a choice (A-D), press CHECK ANSWER, read the explanation -- every question teaches the trap, not merely the answer -- then press NEXT QUESTION. SCENARIO questions present shared CASE FACTS in a highlighted panel; several consecutive questions may draw on the same facts, exactly as the real examination does.

6.1 POINT SCHEDULE

ITEM TYPE	POINTS
Multiple choice	10
Scenario (case-based)	20
HARD designation bonus	+5

BADGE THRESHOLD: 80% of module's maximum points.

6.2 THE GRIND-PROOF RULE (IMPORTANT)

Points are banked ONLY on improvement over your previous best score for that module. Retaking a quiz you have mastered yields zero new points. You cannot farm the same easy quiz to reach Board Ready. We know you thought about it. The 1995 equivalent was photocopying your own certificate; it did not work then either.

CHAPTER 7: RANKS, BADGES, AND STREAKS

7.1 THE RANK LADDER

RANK	POINTS REQ'D	OFFICE EQUIVALENT
Intern	0	Knows where the fax is
Analyst	150	Trusted with the binder
Paraplanner	400	Drafts the meeting agenda
Associate Planner	800	Has own coffee mug
Lead Planner	1,400	Runs the Monday meeting
Board Ready	2,200	Schedule the Prometric exam

7.2 BADGES are earned per module at 80%+ and displayed on the trail page with a star. 7.3 THE STREAK increments on each consecutive calendar day with study activity (a card viewed or quiz finished). Miss a day and it resets to 1, accompanied by the faint sound of a modem disconnecting.

CHAPTER 8: ADDING YOUR OWN CONTENT

CFP/TRAILS contains no database, no CMS, and no admin panel. Content is TypeScript. This is a feature: every new question arrives as a GitHub pull request, which means every question gets a code review. Your question bank acquires an audit trail, which should please anyone who has ever worked in compliance.

8.1 PROCEDURE

- STEP 1. Copy content/trails/tax-planning.ts to a new file, e.g. content/trails/investments.ts.
- STEP 2. Write your modules, questions, and flash cards in the Trail structure. Tag every question with its blueprint topic code (e.g. "D.3").
- STEP 3. In content/index.ts, replace the matching stub with your import.
- STEP 4. Open a pull request. Argue politely about answer C.
- STEP 5. Merge. Vercel redeploys automatically. There is no STEP 6.

8.2 HOUSE STYLE FOR QUESTIONS

(a) State assumed dollar figures IN THE STEM -- the real exam provides tax tables, and stems that carry their own figures never go stale. (b) Every explanation must teach the trap, not just restate the answer. (c) Difficulty 2 means harder than the exam. Use it.

CHAPTER 9: TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
My progress vanished.	Progress lives in your browser's localStorage. Clearing site data, private browsing, or switching browsers/devices resets it. v1.0 has no accounts by design; cloud sync is on the roadmap.
I clicked RESET PROGRESS as a joke.	The button does exactly what it says. We are sorry for your loss. There is no undo. There was no undo in 1995 either.
The quiz says my answer is wrong but I disagree.	Excellent -- that is studying. Check the explanation, then the blueprint topic code, then open a GitHub issue with a citation.
A trail says IN DEVELOPMENT.	That domain has no content yet. See Chapter 8 and become the hero of your study group.
The fonts look different on first load.	Typefaces load from the network with system fallbacks. This is normal and lasts under a second on anything faster than a 14.4k modem.
Drive A: makes a grinding noise.	Remove the diskette. There was never a diskette. Please see a professional about the diskette.

APPENDIX A: THE EXAM BLUEPRINT

The eight Principal Knowledge Domains and their approximate published exam weights, as implemented in this release:

DOM	TITLE	WEIGHT	STATUS
A	Professional Conduct & Regulation	8%	In development
B	General Principles of Fin. Planning	15%	In development
C	Risk Management & Insurance	11%	In development
D	Investment Planning	17%	In development
E	Tax Planning	14%	LIVE (22 Q)
F	Retirement Savings & Income	18%	LIVE (23 Q)
G	Estate Planning	10%	In development
H	Psychology of Financial Planning	7%	In development
TOTAL		100%	

Weights are set by CFP Board's practice analysis and may be revised between exam cycles; consult cfp.net for the current outline.

APPENDIX B: REGISTRATION CARD

Complete and mail this card to receive absolutely nothing, as the address does not exist. Starring the repository on GitHub achieves the same result instantly and saves a stamp.

8< - - - - - CUT ALONG DOTTED LINE - - - - - 8<

```

+-----+
|                CFP/TRAILS v1.0 PRODUCT REGISTRATION                |
| NAME: _____ |
| FIRM:  _____ |
| WHERE DID YOU HEAR ABOUT CFP/TRAILS?                               |
| [ ] Office admin who codes   [ ] Word of mouth                     |
| [ ] Computer magazine       [ ] A surprisingly capable AI           |
| CURRENT RANK:  [ ] Intern    [ ] Paraplanner    [ ] Board Ready     |
| MAIL TO: CFP/TRAILS Registration Dept., P.O. Box 1995,             |
|           Floppy Disk, NC 28803                                     |
+-----+

```

8< - - - - - 8<

CFP/TRAILS v1.0 -- DOC. NO. CT-1995-001 REV A -- This manual was lovingly typeset in Courier, the only font that ever mattered. No floppy disks were harmed in the making of this software.